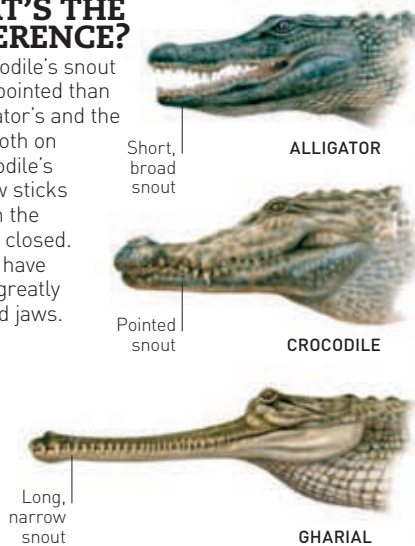


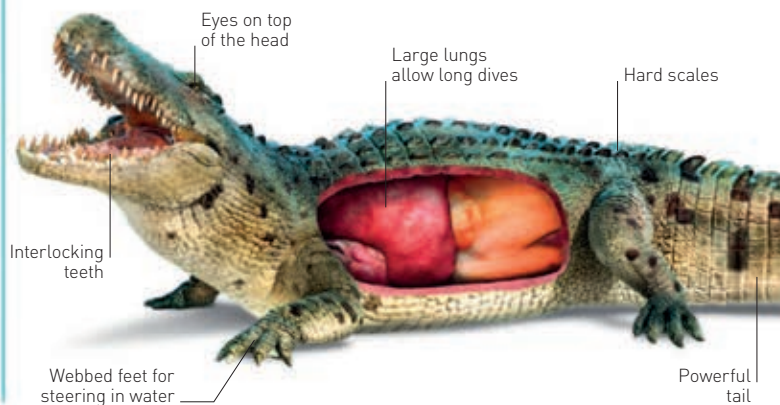
WHAT'S THE DIFFERENCE?

The crocodile's snout is more pointed than the alligator's and the fourth tooth on the crocodile's lower jaw sticks out when the mouth is closed. Gharials have narrow, greatly elongated jaws.



ARMOURED BODY

A crocodilian's long body and tail are covered in tough scales. The short legs allow limited movement on land. With eyes, ears, and nostrils on top of its head, a crocodilian can hunt while almost fully under water. The lungs hold enough oxygen for a 15-minute dive.



PARENTING

Eggs are laid in a nest built and fiercely guarded by the female. After the eggs have hatched, the mother usually remains with her young for a time to protect them.



JUST HATCHED

The mother carries her newly hatched young in her mouth to take them to the water.

Crocodiles and alligators

Crocodylians – crocodiles, alligators, and gharials – have been around since the time of the dinosaurs. They use stealth to ambush prey and their ferocious jaws to kill. These reptiles live partly in water and partly on land.

SURPRISE AMBUSH

Feeding on fish, birds, reptiles, and mammals, crocodilians are masters of the surprise attack. Small prey is swallowed whole, but larger animals must first be drowned before they can be eaten.



1 WAITS
With just eyes, ears, and tip of snout above the water, a crocodile waits almost motionless for unsuspecting prey to come near.



2 LUNGES
Without warning, the crocodile launches itself from the water and seizes its victim with powerful jaws that snap shut around the animal.



3 KILLS
With a strong grip on its prey, the crocodile dives down beneath the water and waits for the animal to drown.

CROCODILES

Found in tropical regions, these reptiles occupy both freshwater and saltwater habitats. The two largest and most dangerous species are the saltwater crocodile and the Nile crocodile.



WITH THE STRONGEST BITE OF ANY LIVING CREATURE, A MALE SALTWATER CROCODILE CAN CRUSH A BUFFALO'S SKULL

